

(WASHINGTON, DC) - Tuesday, House Leaders announced that House members will not receive a pay raise in 2010. The Appropriations Committee has been instructed to include language in the fiscal year 2010 Legislative Branch appropriations bill that would block any pay increase for House members.

"I applaud House Leadership for finally listening to the American people. I do not believe that a congressional pay raise of any amount is appropriate at a time when our nation is at war and our federal budget deficit is rising," said Wittman.

"I believe that our nation's leaders have a duty to set a patriotic and responsible example, in my mind, increasing our own salaries when our military service personnel are still faced with a pay gap and American families are tightening their budgets is emphatically not part of that example," said Wittman.

Wittman has been calling for the freeze for months and is a cosponsor H.R. 156 introduced by Rep. Harry Mitchell of Arizona. The legislation would eliminate automatic pay increases for Members of Congress. Under the terms of a 1989 law, members of Congress automatically receive an annual cost-of-living pay increase unless they act to stop it. The annual increases are based on a formula calculated by the Bureau of Labor Statistics, which takes into consideration changes in private industry wages and salaries.

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(WASHINGTON, DC) - Congressman Russ Carnahan (MO-3) issued the following statement reacting to President Obama's latest remarks on the status of health care reform legislation.

"While progress has been stalled by partisan bickering and profiteers of the status quo in Washington, the costs of health insurance have continued to increase for thousands of Missourians. Don't take my word for it. Simply look to how much you were paying a year, five and ten years ago where on average the rates have doubled.

"The fact is, health care costs are climbing out of reach for far too many Americans - Americans who could afford it just a few years ago. Doing nothing is simply not an option. We need to rein in costs by passing reforms that hold insurance companies accountable. After months and years of debate, we can pass health insurance reform that includes strong ideas from both parties.

"It's time to have an up or down vote on whether to reform our health care system. Those who oppose holding health insurance companies accountable by forcing them to put patients first may try blocking needed reforms, but I refuse to turn my back on people I represent when our broken system requires action to improve our economy and our health care."

-- Congressman Russ Carnahan (MO-3)

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